Increasing Zomato Reviews

The goal is to increase the number of reviews on the platform

Team: Zomato Product Management team
Contributors: Shruti Gaikwad
Status: Product Development

Problem Definition

What is the problem?

Problem faced is that there is no incentive for the users to add a review or rate after the food parcel is delivered.

Who is facing the problem?

The problem is mostly faced by the users between the age group of 18-30 living in tier 1 & 2 cities.

What is the business value that will be unlocked by solving the problem?

Zomato gets its revenue by various sources like getting **commission from restaurant orders**, subscription services, **Advertisements**, food delivery fee, event ticketing and **Partnerships.** Increasing the number of reviews will increase the visibility of Zomato and help increase customer satisfaction. This will increase the number of orders placed on Zomato and increased brand partnerships.
Targeted users face pain points like:

- Bad quality food and health issues
- No reviews for food recommendations
- No motivation to put reviews
- No actual insight on actual restaurant food quality

All these issues will be solved by this solution

Why is it urgent to solve this problem now?

Addressing the issue of incentivizing reviews on Zomato right now is critical due to the rapidly evolving market dynamics, changing consumer behaviour's, and the technological advancements that make such initiatives feasible and effective. By implementing a reward system for reviews, Zomato can enhance customer engagement, improve retention, boost revenue, and maintain a competitive edge in the food delivery market.

1. In order to maintain a competitive edge since the food delivery market is becoming increasingly saturated. Implementing a reward system for reviews can set Zomato apart from competitors who may not yet be leveraging this strategy effectively.
2. Post-pandemic, consumers are more reliant on online reviews than ever before. Studies show that a significant percentage of consumers read reviews before making

purchasing decisions. Failing to capitalize on this trend can result in missed opportunities for user acquisition and retention.

3. Encouraging reviews and responding to them shows that Zomato values customer feedback and is committed to continuous improvement.
4. More reviews can improve Zomato's search engine ranking, leading to increased organic traffic and visibility. Higher visibility can attract more users and drive business growth.
5. With fluctuating economic conditions, consumers are more cautious about where they spend their money. Reviews provide the assurance they need to choose Zomato confidently.

Goals

FUNCTIONAL GOALS:

- Increasing the number of text reviews per month
- Increasing ratings after food delivery on Zomato
- Increased User Retention
- Number of reviewers onboarded per month
- Increasing review section adoption rate
- Reducing false and spam reviews

NON- FUNCTIONAL GOALS:

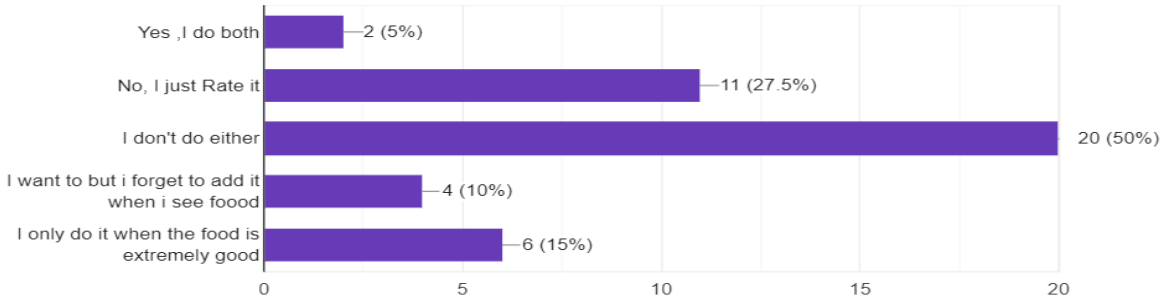
- Handling increased load on the app
- Partnership with other brands
- Push notifications
- There should be no downtime
- People must get their rewards
- Ease of navigating to the review section is included

Non-Goals

- Ease of adding the reviews
- Review completion rate not included

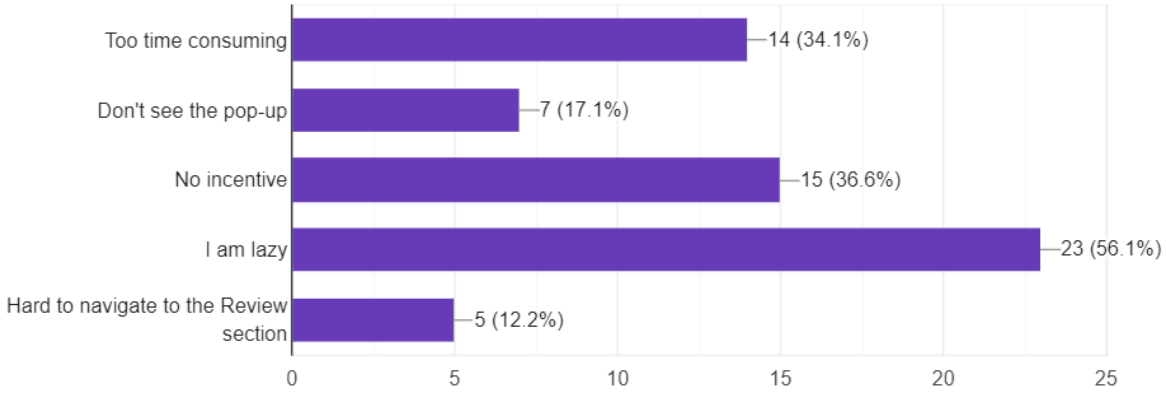
Validation of the problem

The user research suggest that around 20% of the users don't rate or review the order and only 2% of them do both. 50% people avoid putting a review or adding ratings.10% need reminder and 15% need excellent food quality. 3% need an incentive to add a review and almost 97% will mostly put reviews if they are rewarded



Why do you choose to not Rate or write reviews

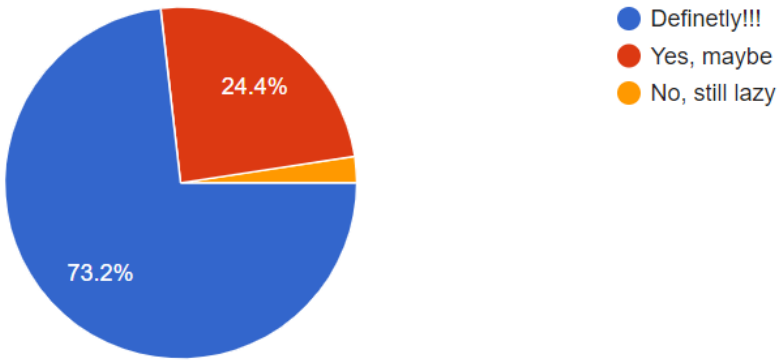
41 responses



The entire survey narrows down to the problem of how the process of review is time consuming, not incentivized, hard to navigate and not reminded of.

Would you add ratings and reviews if Zomato gave you rewards for the same.

41 responses



COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE:

Zomato was the leading with 45%, Swiggy 35%, Dominos 8%, Eatsure 5%, Dunzo 3% and others 4% approximate.

Rating and Reviewing system:

1. Swiggy

User Experience: After a delivery, users receive a prompt to rate the delivery and the food separately. The interface is simple, with a star rating system and an option to leave written feedback.

Incentives: Occasionally offers discounts or coupons for users who leave reviews. Swiggy has also experimented with gamification, rewarding frequent reviewers with badges.

Unique Features: Allows users to rate individual dishes, not just the overall restaurant experience.

2. Uber Eats

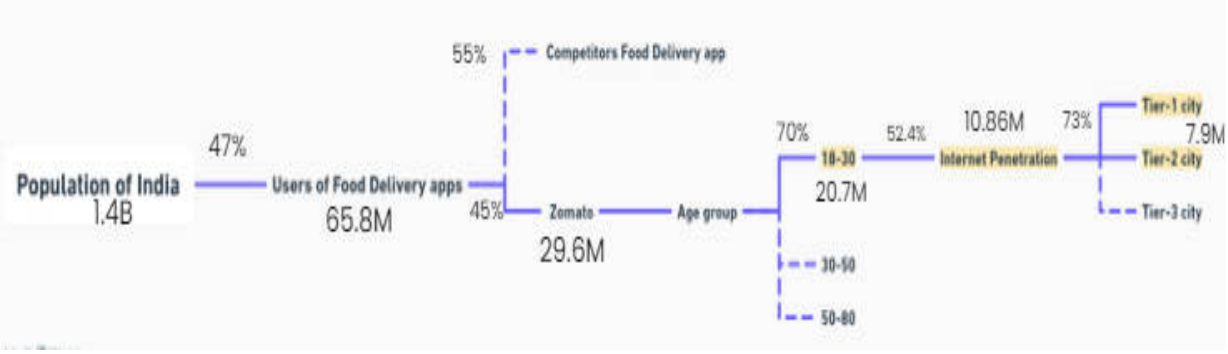
User Experience: Users are prompted to rate their delivery experience and food quality separately. The review process is straightforward, with a star rating system and optional comments.

Incentives: Periodic promotions and discounts for leaving reviews, although these are not consistently applied.

Unique Features: Uber Eats leverages its broader Uber ecosystem by integrating ratings across services. For example, a user's overall experience with Uber can influence their engagement with Uber Eats.

Understanding the target audience

The Target audience for this feature is the people between the age of 18-30 years living in tier 1 & 2 cities. Zomato targets the young generation who like to experiment on their choice of restaurants. Majority of customers in this segment are students and working professionals, who belong to the dual income households (18-30) age group living in tier 1&2 cities).They are also major users of smartphone and digitally more active.



The size of the segment is huge and includes around 8M population of India.

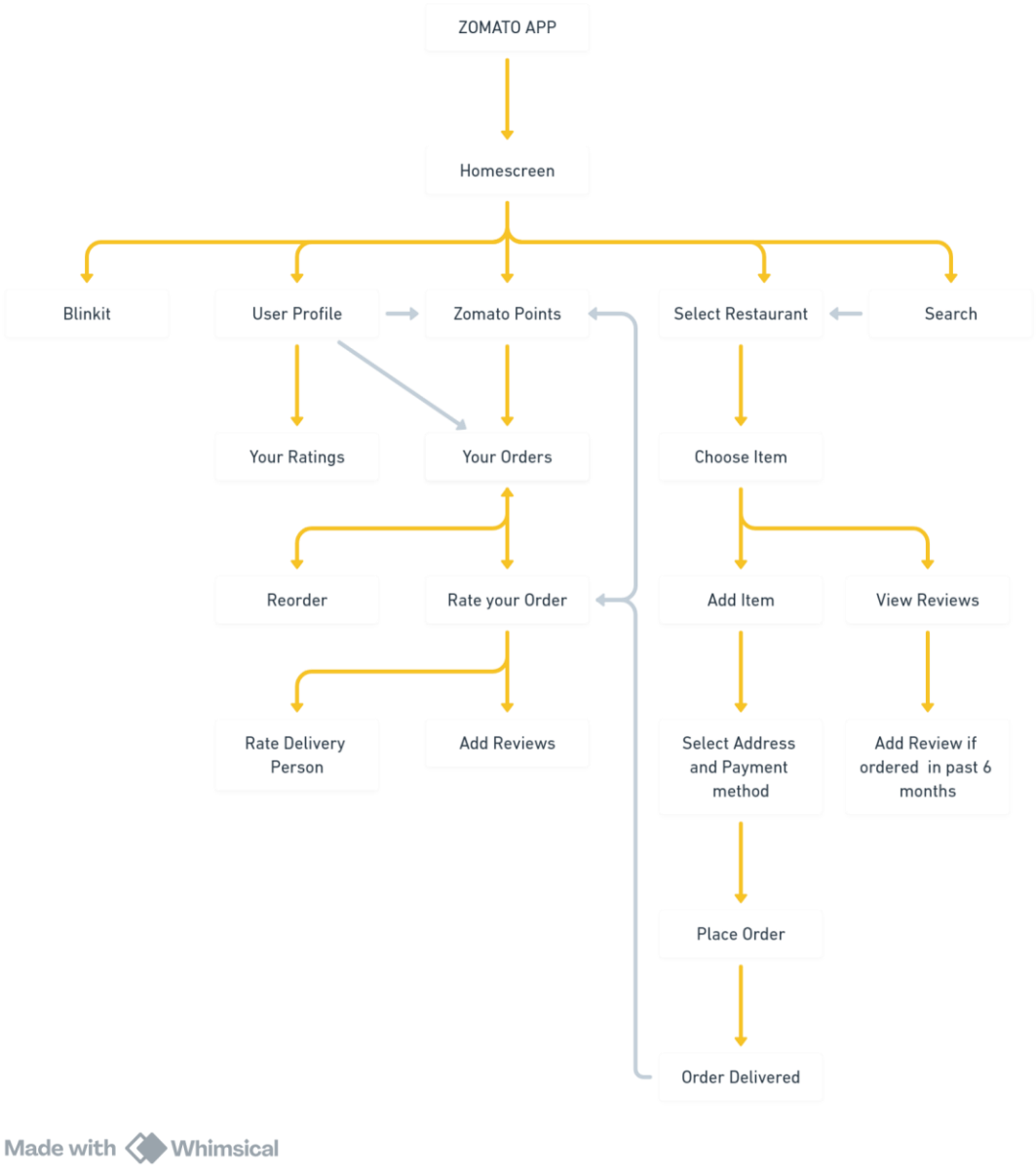


Solution

Based on the learnings from the user research, rewarding the customers for putting a review seems a very important task in order to tackle this problem.
-Zomato Points is a section in the app through which users can track their progress in order to get a reward for adding Reviews.
-Upon completion of Milestones like putting reviews for 50,100,200 restaurants, users will stand a chance to win rewards offered by Zomato and its partners.
-Rewards include discount on next orders, cashback on an order, limited free Zomato Gold Subscription, Google pay rewards and many more!
-There is also a leaderboard for maintaining a healthy competition between the users by which they can track where they stand in terms of adding number of reviews
-Users can also share their progress on social media apps and encourage their friends to post reviews.

This solution will increase the user engagement on the app by 43%, decrease the churn rate by 5-10%, increase repeat purchases by 20%. If the number of reviews increases by 20%, it

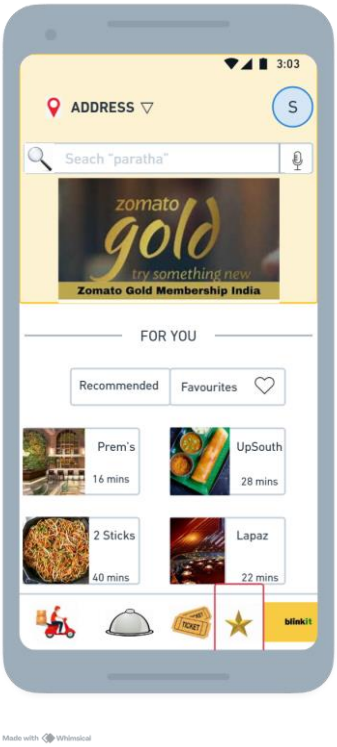
could potentially lead to a 10% increase in order volume due to higher trust and visibility in turn increasing the revenue.



Prioritised features for Phase-1:

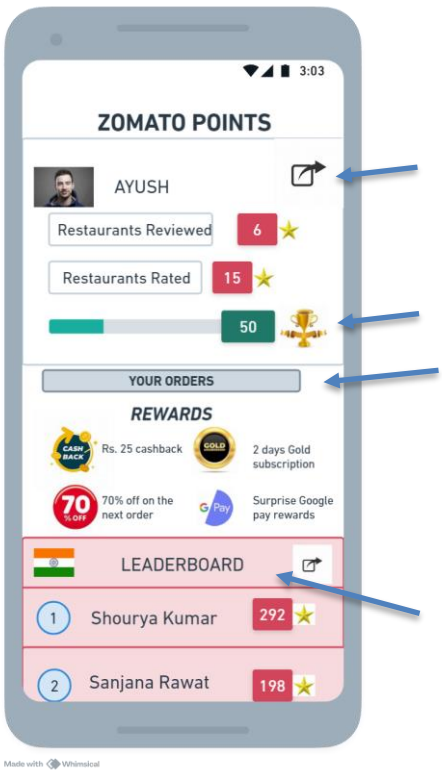
1. Making this feature accessible from the Home page:

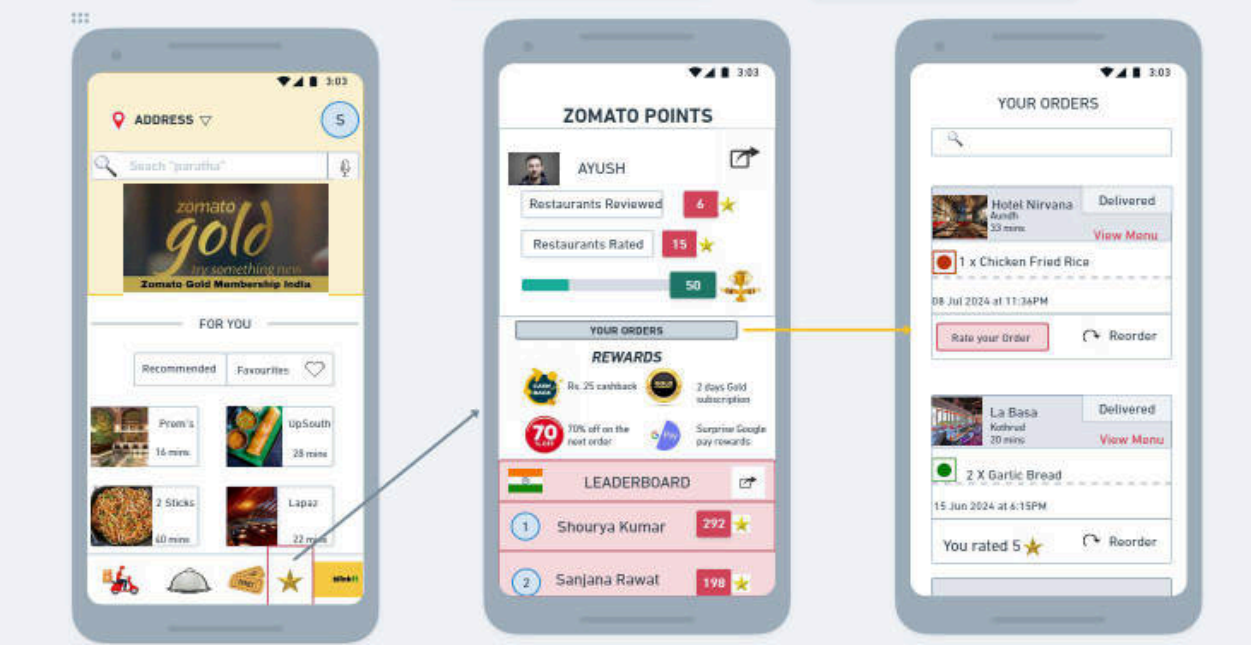
Adding a star icon at the bottom of the page will help to navigate the users to the Zomato points page from the home page.



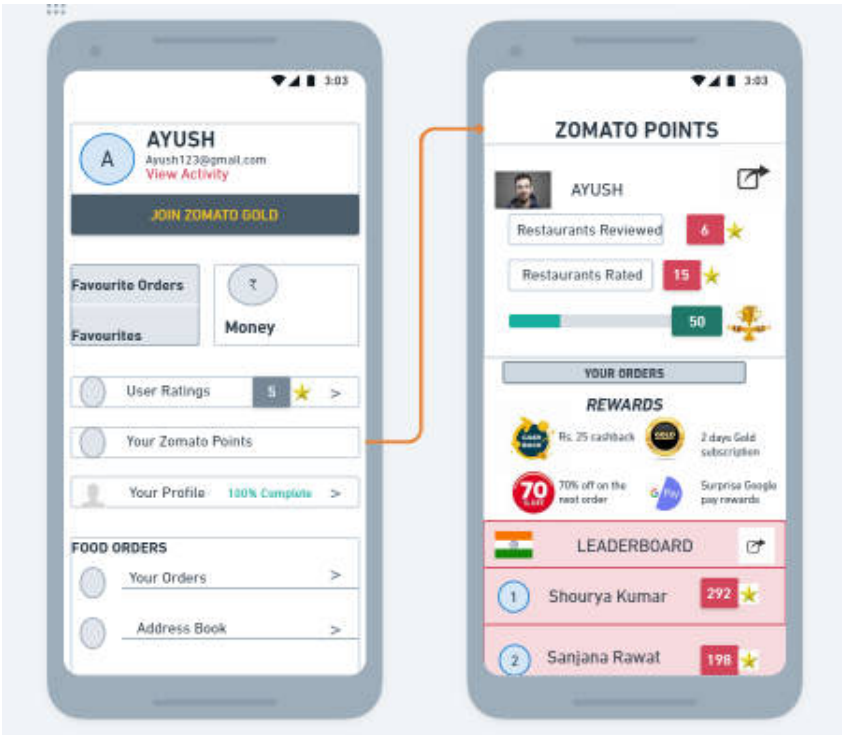
2. Zomato points page:

1) It will have a progress bar to track the number of restaurants rated by the person.
2) Upon completion of the goal the customer will receive one of the rewards mentioned below.
3)The user can also put add reviews to their orders by directly clicking on your orders.
4) Users can check their rank on the leadership board and compare with the others
5)Users can share their progress on various social media platforms.





3. **Making this page accessible from the "*my account*" section:**



ALGORITHM CHANGES:

1)K-Nearest Neighbours- Helps in recommending similar restaurants according to the ones the user has highly rated
2)Support Vector Machines- Filtering out spam reviews

MARKETING:

1)Advertisement campaigns on television
2)Instagram ads and influencer marketing
3) Creative push notifications
4)Organic marketing: Increasing reviews will increase the SEO and visibility on search engines. The share option near the leaderboard will also help the customers share their ranking and compete amongst each other which will create the hype.
5)Increasing the number of business listings
6) Asking the delivery person to prompt the customers for putting in a review through verbal marketing.

KEY METRICS:

North star Metric: Number of restaurants reviewed using Zomato points section (through your orders)

L1 Metric:

- Number of users interacting with the pop-up
- Number of users active on the leaderboard
- Number of users writing review using your orders tab on zomato points/ Number of users interacting with the pop-up

Launch Readiness

Key Milestones:

1. Design Complete: Finalized design documents and stakeholder approval.
2. Development Complete: Completion of backend, frontend, and API development with initial code reviews.
3. QA Timelines: Clear timelines for unit testing, integration testing and system testing
4. Dogfooding: Internal testing by Zomato employees with feedback collection and iteration.

Launch checklist:

1. Pre-Launch Activities: Beta testing, marketing preparation, and documentation.
2. Launch: Soft launch followed by full launch.
3. Post-Launch: Continuous feedback, bug fixes, updates, and performance tracking.

The internal stakeholders include the Company CEO, the design team, product management team, customer support team, finance team, legal team, analytics and data science team marketing team development team, QA team, Brands partnering with Zomato.

The team will experiment this feature with the college going students and evaluate the response.

Future iterations

The future iterations will work on the following features:

- Leaderboard might be removed based on the response of the users.
- Reduction of monetary rewards and discounts
- Introduction of games in the section to increase engagement
- The number of restaurants needed to be reviewed to get a reward also changes

Ideas parked for later

- Making use of generative AI to make this process faster
- More simplified user experience

Risks & Mitigations

RISK	MITIGATION
Users making multiple accounts just to put the same/false reviews and get rewards	Machine learning tools
Partners backout and no rewards	In-house rewards by Zomato and partnership with new brands who are in need of marketing
Company faces loss as a cost of incentivizing people	Charging the partners for marketing and no in-house rewards
Customers might not take interest in the features if they don't find the rewards good enough	Partnership with big brands for free
Not good ROI from marketing	Cut-down on social media marketing and focus on organic marketing
Negligible increase in reviews	Trying a new version
Delivery Person demanding more salary for additional marketing	Increasing the salaries

Open Questions & Decisions Taken

- The current solution does not really take the finances in account.
- How can we combine AI to modify the feature.
- Will this feature need active help of the customer care team

Appendix

- https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1mSHMgUCk94GT6WN78kgLondxxh0vgQtEDKhrFig5NUo/edit#responses
- https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeEHJWb4HwBmf6qSytn-Urc-H9Y81DXwfFWFaJlRnIYITWWVA/viewform

- https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/growth-marketing-and-sales/our-insights/experience-led-growth-a-new-way-to-create-value
- https://whimsical.com/user-flow-7raAvjXvncc8GYzmnmbuMH
- https://www.aha.io/roadmapping/guide/product-diagrams-and-flowcharts
- https://nikhilborkar.medium.com/competitive-analysis-of-the-indian-food-delivery-industry-zomato-swiggy-ubereats-and-foodpanda-30bd99faece8